

Advertising opportunities

Paid commercial advertising on the back cover, and often inside, was a common feature to help keep costs low. As new editions of timetables were published frequently, it became practical to advertise items of short-term interest, such as films, or consumer products and services, such as jewellery, watches, electrical goods, or even hotel accommodations. The BB&CI's July 1945 timetable included stills from the historical drama *Ek Din Ka Sultan* (1945), and a bound-in bookmark, printed in colour.

Effects of World War II

Day to day needs of regular travellers became the focus during World War II. Some railway companies, such as the Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GIPR), promised travellers improvements in its post-war equipment and services in its December 1942 timetable. As the war progressed, these booklets became slimmer and less detailed, though companies continued to promise better conditions to come. Its proprietors, however, had probably not envisioned that the post-war improvements would take place under an independent India.